



DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY

COMMANDER IN CHIEF
UNITED STATES PACIFIC FLEET
250 MAKALAPA DRIVE
PEARL HARBOR, HAWAII 96860-7000

IN REPLY REFER TO:

9 December 1994

[REDACTED]
CWO4 (Comm), USNR (Ret)
[REDACTED]

Dear Chief Warrant Officer W4 Hau,

This is in response to your letter of 18 November 1994 to the Chief of Naval Operations Freedom of Information Act Office. That office has forwarded your letter to Commander in Chief, U.S. Pacific Fleet for response.

There is no legal problem with you discussing your personal experience while embarked on the USS FRANKLIN D. ROOSEVELT. I assume you were never told anything you observed was classified. If you were, however, I'd need to know more about the circumstances. Absent this, feel free to discuss your experience with SIGHTINGS.

Sincerely,

[REDACTED]

CDR, JAGC, USN
Deputy Fleet Judge Advocate

Copy to: .
CNO (09B30)

UFO SIGHTING

At about 2130P/25 or 26 July 1956 (0030Z/25 or 26 July 1956), I was standing a signal watch in USS FRANKLIN D. ROOSEVELT (CVA 42), then anchored in Rio de Janeiro Harbor, Brazil. The sky was clear.

As I recall, the signal bridge was called by Combat Information Center asking for visual verification of an air search radar contact in our vicinity, holding stationary. Inspection revealed a cigar-shaped object estimated to be 5000 feet, close by the zenith. It was displaying at least one row of white lights, -- I do not remember if any were flashing.

After about 10 or 15 minutes, it suddenly started moving in a northerly direction, accelerating smoothly and rapidly, until it disappeared from view in one or two minutes. It may have disappeared more quickly than that, as CIC later said it went off their radar scope "in two or three sweeps." Unfortunately, I did not think to ask what range scale they were using at the time.

The incident^y was reported to the Officer of the Deck and I am sure to the Commanding Officer (Captain  USN). The sighting was certainly noteworthy enough to have been logged both in the CIC Watch Officer's Log and the smooth Deck Log. Copies of the latter would be available from the Ships Histories Branch, Naval Historical Center, Washington Navy Yard, Washington DC 20374.


CWO4, USNR